DMP1 UNITS 1-6 BUNDLE

GUIDE

Unit order and pacing

Teacher

Teach the units in this order. It is the course order the units are numbered in, and each unit works as a stand-alone teaching unit.

UNIT	TITLE	DAYS	PERIODS	STUDENTS MAKE	IN THE FOLDER
1	**Beat From Nothing**	4	1–4	an original 16-measure drum beat in AABA form, programmed from nothing in Logic Pro	21 pp + 15 slides
2	**Stems and Grooves**	6	5–10	drums over a stem: two contrasting grooves, then a full song with a transition at each section change	28 pp + 22 slides
3	**Chords by Ear**	5	11–15	major and minor chords labelled with Roman numerals, as a chord layer over a bassline	35 pp + 21 slides
4	**Bass and Melody Writing**	4	16–19	a short melody written from a scale, and a bassline over four chosen chords	30 pp + 22 slides
5	**Song Form**	4	20–23	a song arranged from chords, bass and melody, with at least four sections	27 pp + 17 slides
6	**Spooky Tunes**	6	24–29	a 32-measure score to a one-minute video, with reverb and delay on shared buses	31 pp + 16 slides
	Total	**29**	1–29		**172 pp + 113 slides**

PACING

- The units are planned for about 53-minute class periods, 29 in all: about six school weeks if the class meets five days a week.
- Each unit has its own minute-by-minute day plans (the pacing page near the front of its PDF). Unit 1 has a note on stretching to 5 days, and Unit 5 has a note on running in 3 days if you are short on time.

WHY THIS ORDER

- **Unit 2** builds on Unit 1, Beat From Nothing.
- **Unit 4** picks up where Unit 3 ends: students continue in their Unit 3 project, or use a file made from the recipe on its setup page.
- **Unit 5** arranges a chord progression and bassline students already have, so it follows Units 3 and 4. If they have none, its setup page shows a quick way to make one.
- **Unit 6** needs no key, chord progression or song form (students may work in any key), so you can move it earlier, for example to October for Halloween.

PREVIEW

© 2026 Brian Lotze · Hudson Beat · For single-classroom use

DMP1 UNITS 1-6 BUNDLE

What is in the ZIP

GUIDE

Folder map

DMP1 UNITS 1-6 BUNDLE - HUDSON BEAT

00 START HERE - Bundle Guide.pdf

UNIT 1 - BEAT FROM NOTHING

beat-from-nothing.pdf
beat-from-nothing-intro-deck.pptx
beat-from-nothing-intro-deck.pdf

UNIT 2 - STEMS AND GROOVES

stems-and-grooves.pdf
stems-and-grooves-intro-deck.pptx
stems-and-grooves-intro-deck.pdf

UNIT 3 - CHORDS BY EAR

chords-by-ear.pdf
chords-by-ear-intro-deck.pptx
chords-by-ear-intro-deck.pdf

UNIT 4 - BASS AND MELODY WRITING

bass-melody-writing.pdf
bass-melody-writing-intro-deck.pptx
bass-melody-writing-intro-deck.pdf

UNIT 5 - SONG FORM

song-form.pdf
song-form-intro-deck.pptx
song-form-intro-deck.pdf

UNIT 6 - SPOOKY TUNES

spooky-tunes.pdf
spooky-tunes-intro-deck.pptx
spooky-tunes-intro-deck.pdf

IN EVERY UNIT FOLDER

- **The PDF**: how to use, unit overview and setup, pacing and day plans, teacher notes, student pages, rubric and answer key.
- **The intro deck (.pptx)**: the teacher-presented slides, with speaker notes on every slide.
- **The intro deck (PDF)**: a copy that shows the intended look. The deck uses the free Oswald and Source Sans 3 fonts.

HOW TO START

1. Open this guide, then the folder for Unit 1.
2. Read the unit PDF's how-to-use and pacing pages, then the teacher notes.
3. Present the intro deck on Day 1 and print the student pages.

WHAT YOU SUPPLY

- Logic Pro on a Mac. The steps are written for Logic Pro; the music ideas carry over to other DAWs.
- No audio, video, stems or Logic sessions are included. Where a unit needs a file (stems for Unit 2, a short bassline file for Units 3 and 4, a one-minute video for Unit 6), that unit's setup page explains how to make or find one.
- Songs named in a unit are named for reference only; play them from your own streaming access.

PREVIEW

STEMS & GROOVES

The four transitions

STUDENT

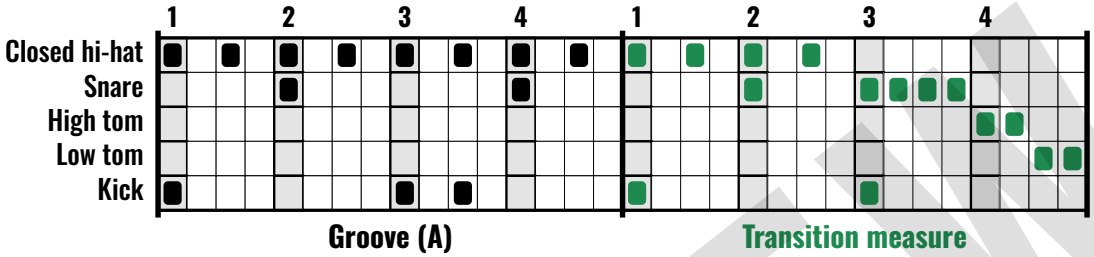
Reference

A transition is the moment between two sections where the drums signal that a change is coming. Each example shows one measure of the groove, then the transition measure (green) right before the new section. Each grid column is a sixteenth note; grey columns are the beats.

1 · DRUM FILL

a rhythmic variation in the last 1–2 measures that signals a change is coming.

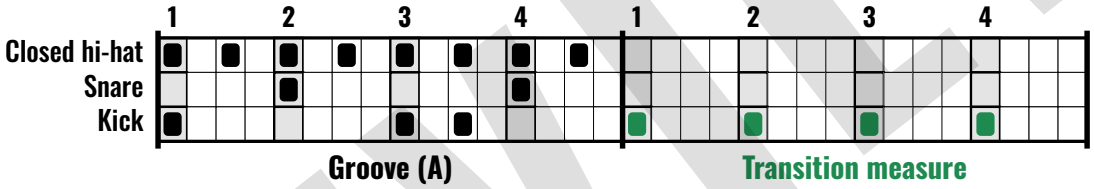
Use it: the classic: works almost anywhere, especially into a bigger section.



2 · BREAKDOWN

strip to one element (kick only, hi-hat only) before the new section hits.

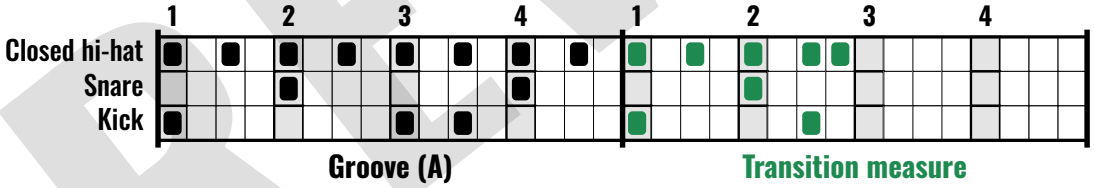
Use it: before a section that should hit harder, or as the music thins out.



3 · CUT

complete silence for 1–2 beats before the next section drops.

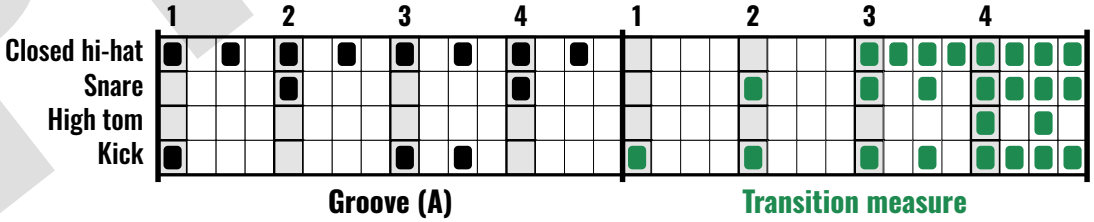
Use it: the most powerful and the easiest to do badly; a cut before a quiet verse.



4 · BUILD

add elements progressively in the last measure to increase energy into the change.

Use it: a build before a big chorus.



PREVIEW

© 2026 Brian Lotze · Hudson Beat · For single-classroom use

C MAJOR — REFERENCE CARD

The Building Blocks · Unit 3 · Keep this open while you work

SCALE ·

C Major — W - W - H - W - W - W - H

C	D	E	F	G	A	B	C	(8)

CHORDS IN THIS KEY ·

RN	TYPE	CHORD	NOTES	FEELS LIKE…
I	Major	**C Major**	C - E - G	*Home. Settled. Complete.*
ii	Minor	**D Minor**	D - F - A	*Gentle tension. Moving somewhere.*
iii	Minor	**E Minor**	E - G - B	*Wistful. In between.*
IV	Major	**F Major**	F - A - C	*Lifting. Hopeful. Away from home.*
V	Major	**G Major**	G - B - D	*Homesick. Wants to resolve to I.*
vi	Minor	**A Minor**	A - C - E	*Tender. Melancholy. Emotional.*
vii°	Dim.	**B Dim.**	B - D - F	*Tense. Unstable. Rarely used alone.*

Remember: Roman numerals describe chord function, not just chord names.

The I chord always feels like home. · The V chord always feels unresolved. · The vi chord always feels tender or melancholy.

These feelings are the same in every key — only the note names change.

No sharps or flats in this key: every chord is white keys only. A minor uses the same seven notes: it is the relative minor.

PREVIEW

© 2026 Brian Lotze · Hudson Beat · For single-classroom use